

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | CISSP | SIEM | EDR/XDR | Incident Response | Threat Intelligence | Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in hands-on security operations, incident response and strategic security advisory, combining third-line technical depth with the ability to translate risk into clear business language for senior stakeholders. I have a strong track record leading Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, managing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, conducting threat hunting, and overseeing end-to-end vulnerability management programmes. I am proficient in Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and I bring experience managing identity security, network security and cloud security controls across large, complex environments. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and CompTIA Security+ certifications, and I am committed to maintaining compliance with frameworks including ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) and Cyber Essentials Plus. I am adept at engaging partners, lawyers and senior leadership, presenting security risk posture clearly and managing sensitive security matters with the discretion appropriate to a professional services environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Operations Centre (SOC):** Alert triage, threat investigation, escalation, threat hunting, detection engineering
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL (moderate)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Expert), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Incident Response (IR):** NIST 800-61, containment and eradication, post-incident review, forensic evidence handling
- **Threat Intelligence:** Indicator of Compromise (IOC) management, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, threat actor profiling
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, risk-based prioritisation
- **Network and Endpoint Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, IDS/IPS, network segmentation, Tanium
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Email Security:** Mimecast
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 (M365)
- **Compliance and Frameworks:** ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer — University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Led Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions for an 8,000-user estate, overseeing alert triage, investigation and escalation across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft 365 Defender, with responsibility for the overall security monitoring posture
- Conducted proactive threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework, Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying adversary activity, lateral movement and persistence mechanisms before they caused material impact

- Managed end-to-end Incident Response (IR) lifecycle in accordance with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication and recovery across technical and non-technical teams and producing post-incident reports for senior leadership
- Produced and integrated Cyber Threat Intelligence (CTI) including Indicator of Compromise (IOC) feeds and threat actor Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) into SIEM detection rules, improving proactive detection coverage
- Delivered vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io and AppCheck; prioritised findings by business risk and tracked remediation through to closure in coordination with infrastructure owners
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO), maintaining a strong identity security posture across the 8,000-user directory
- Implemented and operated BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), governing administrative credential lifecycle, session recording and just-in-time access for server and network infrastructure
- Presented monthly security metrics, risk posture updates and incident summaries to senior stakeholders including the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and Board-level governance committees
- Maintained compliance controls aligned to ISO 27001, NIST CSF and Cyber Essentials Plus, supporting internal and external audit processes
- Delivered security awareness training to staff across the organisation, reducing phishing susceptibility and improving security culture

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity — University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed tier 2 and tier 3 SOC analyst duties, handling alert investigation, triage and escalation across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon and M365 Defender environments, covering endpoint, identity and cloud-based threat vectors
- Managed vulnerability scanning programmes using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating risk-prioritised remediation with system owners and producing management reporting on patching posture
- Maintained Mimecast email security platform, investigating phishing campaigns, managing allow and block lists and tuning detection policies to reduce email-borne threat exposure
- Developed Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, workbooks and dashboards within Microsoft Sentinel, improving threat visibility across Microsoft 365 and Azure environments
- Contributed to security incident investigations and post-incident reviews, applying NIST 800-61 procedures and MITRE ATT&CK attribution to understand adversary behaviour and improve defensive controls
- Supported the organisation-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), integrating telemetry into the centralised SIEM for unified monitoring
- Managed Azure AD configuration, onboarding and offboarding of 8,000 staff and student accounts, Conditional Access and MFA policies

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure — HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 – March 2022

- Delivered IT security, quality assurance and infrastructure management for a Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform serving global enterprise clients across regulated environments
- Managed endpoint security tools, network monitoring and vulnerability scanning to maintain a strong security posture across the corporate network and SaaS platform
- Implemented and maintained security policies aligned to ISO 27001, supporting internal audit processes and demonstrating compliance with client contractual requirements
- Administered identity and access management (IAM) controls, enforcing least-privilege access through Active Directory and ensuring timely provisioning and de-provisioning
- Collaborated with DevOps and engineering teams to embed security requirements into operational processes, raising security awareness across the business

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) across UAL's 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint telemetry visibility and building custom MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detections to reduce threat dwell time
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender across the 8,000-user UAL environment, integrating all telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for unified Security Operations Centre (SOC) monitoring
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating unmanaged administrative credentials and materially reducing the risk of privileged account compromise and lateral movement
- Built a library of custom detection use cases and threat hunting queries within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, reducing Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) for high-priority threat scenarios
- Led UAL's successful recertification against Cyber Essentials Plus, mapping existing controls to the standard, identifying gaps and driving remediation in advance of the independent assessment
- Implemented Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating phishing triage and account compromise response workflows and significantly reducing analyst Mean Time to Respond (MTTR)

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)